

Install the pipeline, then write your file

about 50 minutes, in two parts

Two parts. First the two plugins that run the pipeline you just saw. Then your own build-instructions file, written with the plugin you just installed. Every lab from here on opens with "use superpowers and your build instructions", and this is where both arrive.

PART 1: INSTALL THE PIPELINE

1. Two plugins

Open the Code screen and start a new session in any folder. Type `/plugin` and press return; the Plugins panel opens. On the **Discover** tab, search for superpowers and click **Add**. Then search for code-simplifier and add that too.

If either isn't in the list, ask Claude instead:

```
Install the superpowers plugin and the code-simplifier plugin from the
official marketplace.
```

2. A new session

Start a new session. The first thing on screen is a block that begins "You have superpowers." That's a hook from the plugin, running before you've typed anything.

3. Look at what came in

Ask:

```
What agents do you have?
```

code-simplifier is in the list. Then open `/plugin`, the **Yours** tab, and look inside superpowers: the skills, and the hook.

PART 2: WRITE YOUR FILE

Your instructions file is `~/ .claude/CLAUDE.md`, the one Claude reads at the start of every session in every folder. You're going to have Claude help you choose a method and write it. The file on the screen is the instructor's; it's the shape, not the text to copy.

4. One prompt

New session, any folder. Type:

```
I want a personal build-instructions file at ~/ .claude/CLAUDE.md so every
project I start follows one method. Help me choose between Karpathy's
small-steps pipeline, Kent Beck's test-first augmented coding and
spec-driven development, then write the file: a section of code simplicity
rules and a section on how a build should run.
```

5. Answer, then choose

Brainstorming fires. It asks what you build, how you check work, how much you want to read. Answer briefly. When it offers the approaches, pick one and say why in a sentence.

If it offers to write a spec document first, say no: for a file this size, the file is the spec.

6. Read it in sections

It shows the file in sections. Read each one. Strike anything you wouldn't say yourself. Add the kind of over-building you've seen Claude do to you. Shorter is better: ten to twenty lines is plenty.

7. Approve, then read it whole

Approve. It writes `~/ .claude/CLAUDE.md`. Ask it to show you the whole file and read it once more.

8. Check it loads

New session, anywhere:

```
What rules am I asking you to follow?
```

It should say your rules back. If it doesn't, ask where it looked for your `CLAUDE.md`.

YOU'RE DONE WHEN

- A new session opens with "You have superpowers" and `code-simplifier` is in the agent list.
- A fresh session recites rules you'd say yourself.